

STAGE ELEVEN • TOOLS & TECHNOLOGY

FIRSTS

PARTICIPANT PRE-WORK

A short primer to send before each session, so people arrive oriented

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

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FIRSTS • Participant Pre-Work Handout

Stage Eleven • Tools & Technology

FOR FACILITATORS

Send the relevant section below 2-3 days before each session. This stage's pre-work matters more than most — several FIRSTS require real accounts (GitHub, an AI tool) that take genuine time to set up, and doing that before the session protects real practice time during it.

Before Session 1: Core Productivity & Office Tools

WHAT TO DO BEFORE THIS SESSION

- Bring a laptop with both Microsoft Office and Google Workspace accounts accessible — this session moves between both toolsets.
- Bring one real, current document (a paper, spreadsheet, or presentation) to actually apply skills to during the session.

WHY THIS MATTERS

This session is hands-on and device-dependent throughout. Arriving with the right accounts and a real document means session time goes to genuine skill-building, not setup.

Before Session 2: Personal Systems & Technical Foundations

WHAT TO DO BEFORE THIS SESSION

- Create a free GitHub account before this session if you don't already have one — FIRST O16 requires hands-on access.
- Confirm access to at least one AI tool (a free tier is sufficient) for FIRSTS O17 and O18.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Account creation takes real time and is far better done before the session than during it — this protects session time for actual practice.

Before Session 3: Advanced Tools, Automation & Optimization

WHAT TO DO BEFORE THIS SESSION

- Identify one real, repetitive task in your own life or work — this becomes your working example for FIRSTS O22 and O23.
- This is the final session of the stage; come ready to honestly audit your full tool stack, not just this session's tools.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Having a genuine, specific repetitive task in mind, rather than inventing one on the spot, makes the automation exercises meaningfully more useful.